

PARISHRAM 2027

THE RATTRAP

Lecture -11 Class 12

By Anurag Tyagi Sir

TOPICS TO BE COVERED

ENGLISH LITERATURE

01

WARM-UP GAME

02

THE RATTRAP (Part - 02)

03

EXERCISE AND QUIZ



GAME TIME



The journalist wrote a scathing article about the politician.

A) Praising

✓ B) Harsh

C) Neutral

D) Kind

He solved the puzzle with *finesse* and impressed everyone.

- ☒ A) Skill
- ☐ B) Carelessness
- ☐ C) Strength
- ☐ D) Confusion

THE RATTRAP

By Selma Lagerlof



Key Notes

A poor vagabond

- A hapless victim of want and hunger
- Sells rattraps out of begged material to make both ends meet
- Resorts to begging and stealing for additional income



The vagabond's sombre thought

- The whole world's a big rattrap
- All comforts and joys are nothing but baits to trap
- Succumbing to temptation spells end of everything
- Vagabond enjoys dwelling on this thought during lonely plodding's



A generous host

- Seeks shelter in a small gray cottage by the roadside
- Owner, an old man without wife or children, accommodates him
- Feeds him porridge and treats kindly
- The two smoke and play cards together



The host confides in the vagabond

- Host formerly a crofter at ramsjö ironworks
- Now supported by a milch cow
- Earned thirty kronor in payment last month
- Shows the amount saved in a pouch hung on a nail near the window frame



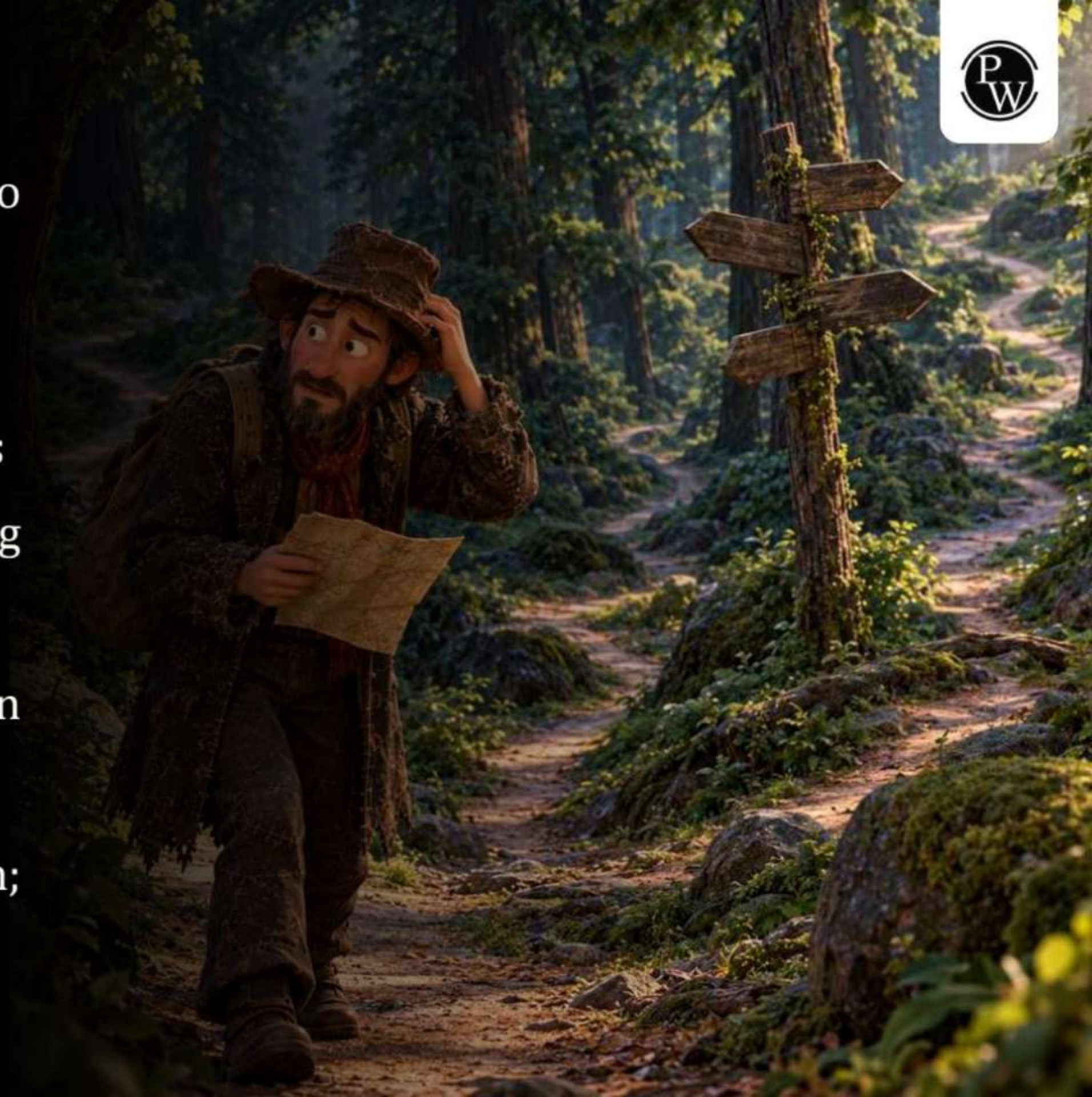
Vagabond steals the money

- Next morning the guest thanks the old man, bids goodbye and goes his own way
- Host locks the house; goes to milk the cow
- Guest returns after half an hour
- Smashes the windowpane
- Steals the money and runs away



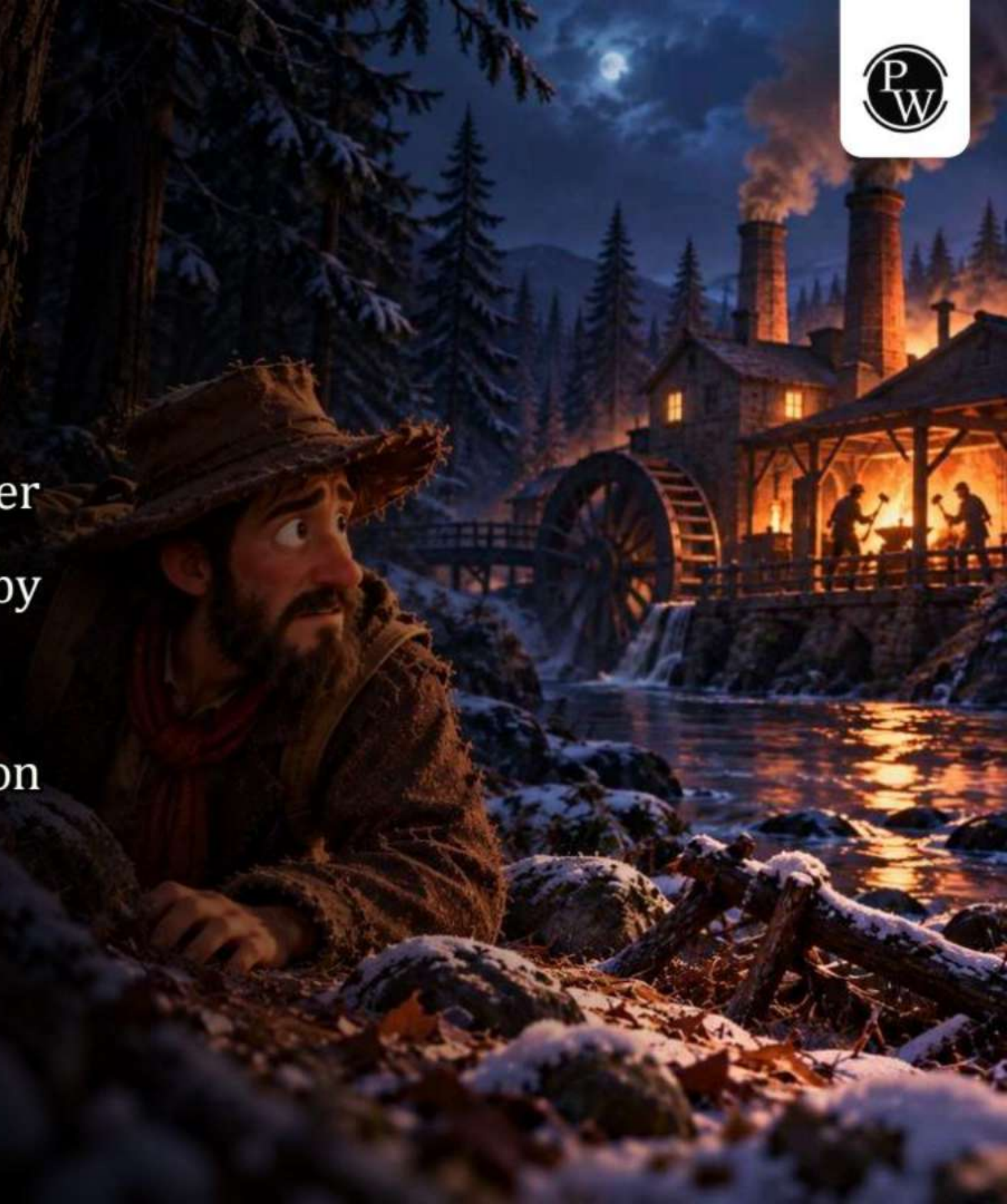
Lost in the forest

- Vagabond discards public highway to avoid getting caught
- Turns off the road into the woods
- Walks through mazes of forest paths
- Lands nowhere as the forest was big and confusing
- Dead tired; realises that he has been trapped
- Forest an impenetrable prison; escape impossible



A hope in the darkness

- Vagabond dejected and apprehensive
- Sees no way out
- Sinks to the ground in despair
- Suddenly hears regular thumping of a hammer
- Realises that an iron mill is somewhere nearby
- Gets another lease of life
- Gathers his strength and walks in the direction of the sound
- Reaches Ramsjo ironworks
- Work in full swing; very noisy place



A detailed illustration of a man in a winter setting. He is wearing a brown hat, a red scarf, and a heavy brown coat. He is carrying a large bundle of sticks over his shoulder and holding several wire cages in his hand. The background shows a snowy landscape with evergreen trees, a full moon, and a small cabin with a warm light emanating from its windows. A wooden fence is visible on the left, and a small heart-shaped light is in the bottom right corner.

THE RATTRAP

By Selma Lagerlof

PART II

(day before Christmas , क्रिसमस की पूर्व संध्या)

The next day was Christmas Eve, and

when the ironmaster came into the
dining room for breakfast he

(perhaps , शायद)

probably thought with satisfaction of

(companion , साथी)

his old regimental comrade whom he

(meet by chance , अचानक मिल जाना)

had run across so unexpectedly.



(ensure , सुनिश्चित करना)

“First of all we must see to it that he gets a little flesh on his bones,” he said to his daughter, who was busy at the table. “And then we must see that he gets something else to do than to run around the country selling rattraps.”



(strange , अजीब)

“It is queer that things have gone
very bad
downhill with him as badly as
that,” said the daughter. “Last night
I did not think there was anything
about him to show that he had
once been an educated man.”



“You must have patience, my little girl,” said the father. “As soon as he gets clean and dressed up, you will see something different. Last night he was naturally embarrassed. The (**homeless wanderer** , घुमक्कड़ / बेघर व्यक्ति) tramp manners will fall away from him with the tramp clothes.”



Just as he said this the door opened and the stranger entered. Yes, now he was truly clean and well dressed. The *valet* (**personal servant** , निजी सेवक) had bathed him, cut his hair, and shaved him. Moreover he was dressed in a good-looking suit of clothes which belonged to the ironmaster. He wore a white shirt (**stiff collar** , कड़क कलफ़ वाला कॉलर) and a *starched collar* and whole shoes.



But although his guest was now so well
(**neatly prepared** , सँवारा हुआ)
groomed, the ironmaster did not seem
(**happy** , खुश)
pleased. He looked at him with puckered
(**wrinkled forehead** , सिकुड़ा हुआ माथा)
brow, and it was easy to understand that
when he had seen the strange fellow in
the uncertain reflection from the furnace
he might have made a mistake,



but that now, when he stood there in broad daylight, it was impossible to
(**known person** , जान-पहचान वाला)
mistake him for an old acquaintance.

(**shouted angrily** , गरजकर कहा)
“What does this mean?” he thundered.

The stranger made no attempt to
(**hide the truth** , सच्चाई छिपाना)
dissimulate. He saw at once that the

(**high status or grand treatment the peddler experienced**)
splendour had come to an end.



“It is not my fault, sir,” he said. “I never

(**acted falsely** , दिखावा किया)

pretended to be anything but a poor

(**requested earnestly** , विनती की)

trader, and I pleaded and begged to be

allowed to stay in the forge. But no harm

(**wear** , पहनना)

has been done. At worst I can put on my

(**torn clothes** , फटे कपड़े)

rags again and go away”.



“Well,” said the ironmaster, hesitating a little, “it was not quite honest, either. You must admit that, and I should not be surprised if the sheriff would like to have something to say in the matter.”

The tramp took a step forward and (**hit** , मारा) struck the table with his fist.



“Now I am going to tell you, Mr Ironmaster, how things are,” he said.

“This whole world is nothing but a big rattrap. All the good things that are offered to you are nothing but cheese

(**outer pieces**) (**placed** , रखा गया)
rinds and bits of pork, set out to drag a

(**small pieces** , टुकड़े)
poor fellow into trouble.



And if the sheriff comes now and locks
(imprisons me , मुझे जेल में डाल देता है)
me up for this, then you, Mr Ironmaster,
must remember that a day may come
when you yourself may want to get a big
piece of pork, and then you will get
caught in the trap.”

The ironmaster began to laugh.



“That was not so badly said, my good fellow. Perhaps we should let the sheriff alone on Christmas Eve. But now get out of here as fast as you can.”

But just as the man was opening the door, the daughter said, “I think he ought to stay with us today. I don’t want him to go.” And with that she went and closed the door.



“What in the world are you doing?” said the father.

The daughter stood there quite embarrassed and hardly knew what to answer. That morning she had felt so happy when she thought how homelike and Christmassy she was going to make (**miserable person** , बेचारा / दुखी व्यक्ति) things for the poor hungry wretch.



She could not get away from the idea all at once, and that was why
(**pleaded for** , पक्ष में विनती की)
she had interceded for the
vagabond.



“I am thinking of this stranger here,” said the young girl. “He walks and walks the whole year long, and there is probably not a single place in the whole country where he is welcome and can feel at home.”



Wherever he turns he is chased away. Always he is afraid of being arrested and cross-examined. I should like to have him enjoy a day of peace with us here — just one in the whole year.”



The ironmaster mumbled something in
(**spoke unclearly** , बड़बड़ाया)
his beard. He could not bring himself to
oppose her.

“It was all a mistake, of course,” she
continued. “But anyway I don’t think we
(**should** , चाहिए) (**drive away** , भगा देना)
ought to chase away a human being
whom we have asked to come here, and
to whom we have promised Christmas
(**happiness** , खुशी)
cheer.”



(**looked displeased** , भौंहें सिकोड़ना)

The ironmaster frowned and replied,

(**lecture too much** , पादरी से भी ज़्यादा उपदेश देना)

“You do preach worse than a parson,”

said the ironmaster. “I only hope you won’t have to regret this.”

The young girl took the stranger by the hand and led him up to the table.

“Now sit down and eat,” she said, for she

(**yielded** , मान गया)

could see that her father had given in.



The man with the rat traps said not a word; he only sat down and helped himself to the food. Time after time he looked at the young girl who had interceded for him. Why had she done it? What could the crazy idea be?



After that, Christmas Eve at Ramsjö passed just as it always had. The stranger did not cause any trouble because he did nothing but sleep. The

(**morning** , पूर्वाह्न / सुबह)
whole forenoon he lay on the sofa in one of the guest rooms and slept at
(**continuously** , लगातार)
one stretch.



At noon they woke him up so that
he could have his share of the
(food , भोजन)
good Christmas *fare*, but after that
he slept again. It seemed as
though for many years he had not
been able to sleep as quietly and
safely as here at Ramsjö.



In the evening, when the Christmas tree
(**awakened** , जगाया)
was lighted, they woke him up again, and
he stood for a while in the drawing
(**closing and opening eyes quickly** , पलकें झपकाना)
room, blinking as though the candlelight
hurt him, but after that he disappeared

(**awakened** , फिर से जगाया)
again. Two hours later he was aroused
once more. He then had to go down into
the dining room and eat the Christmas
(**soft cereal food** , दलिया)
fish and porridge.



As soon as they got up from the table he went around to each one present and said thank you and good night, but when he came to the young girl she gave him to understand that it was her father's (**plan** , इरादा) intention that the suit which he wore was to be a Christmas present — he did not have to return it;



and if he wanted to spend next Christmas Eve in a place where he could rest in peace, and be sure that no evil (**happen to** , होना / घटित होना) would befall him, he would be welcomed back again.

The man with the rattraps did not (**looked fixedly** , टकटकी लगाकर देखा) answer anything to this. He only stared at the young girl in boundless (**great surprise** , असीम आश्चर्य) amazement.



Q. What did the peddler say in his defense when it was clear that he was not the person the ironmaster had thought he was?

- A) He claimed he was lost and looking for shelter.
- B) He admitted he was a poor man without any bad intentions. ✓
- C) He argued that he was trying to escape from the police.
- ✓ D) He said he had never claimed to be the ironmaster's friend.

Q. Why did Edla still entertain the peddler even after she knew the truth about him?

- A) She didn't want to upset her father.
- B) She wanted to prove her father wrong by proving that the peddler was indeed his comrade.
- C) She hoped to gain something from him later.
- ☒ D) She felt sorry for him and his miserable condition out of her kind nature.

The next morning the
ironmaster and his daughter got
(**proper time** , समय पर / जल्दी)
up in good season to go to the
(**church worship** , चर्च की प्रार्थना सभा)
early Christmas service. Their
guest was still asleep, and they
did not disturb him.



(travelled by carriage , गाड़ी से लौटे)

When, at about ten o'clock, they drove

back from the church, the young girl sat

(bent down , झुका हुआ)

and with her head bowed, looking even

(sad , उदास)

more dejected than usual. At church she

had learned that one of the old crofters

of the ironworks had been robbed by a

man who went around selling rattraps.



“Yes, that was a fine fellow you let into the house,” said her father. “I only wonder how many silver spoons are left in the cupboard by this time.”

(**cabinet** , अलमारी)

(**carriage** , गाड़ी)

The wagon had hardly stopped at the front steps when the ironmaster asked the valet whether the stranger was still there.

(**personal servant** , निजी सेवक)



He added that he had heard at church
that the man was a thief. The valet
(**man** , आदमी)
answered that the fellow had gone and
that he had not taken anything with him
(**opposite** , विपरीत)
at all. On the contrary, he had left behind
a little package which Miss Willmansson
was to be kind enough to accept as a
(**gift** , उपहार)
Christmas present.



The young girl opened the package,
(**wrapped** , लपेटा हुआ)
which was so badly done up that the
contents came into view at once. She
gave a little cry of joy. She found a small
(**creased** , मुड़े-तुड़े)
rattrap, and in it lay three wrinkled ten
kronor notes. But that was not all. In the
rattrap lay also a letter written in large,
(**uneven** , टेढ़े-मेढ़े)
jagged characters —



“Honoured and noble Miss,

Since you have been so nice to me all day long, as if I was a captain, I want to be nice to you, in return, as if I was a real captain — for I do not want you to be embarrassed at this Christmas season by a thief; but you can give back the money to the old man on the roadside, who has the money pouch hanging on the window frame as a bait for poor wanderers.

The rattrap is a Christmas present from a rat who would have been caught in this world’s rattrap if he had not been raised to captain, because in that way he got power to clear himself.

*Written with friendship and high regard,
Captain von Stahle.”*

MESSAGE



1. Everyone deserves a second chance.
2. Love, care & Compassion have transformative power.
3. Never judge a person !
4. It's never too late to become what you want to be.

Q. Why was Edla happy to see the gift left by the peddler?

- A) It was a valuable item.
- ✓ B) It showed the peddler's change of heart.
- C) It proved the peddler's true identity.
- D) It was something she had always wanted

Q. Why did the peddler sign himself as Captain von Stahle?



- A) He wanted to deceive Edla further.
- B) He wanted to mock the ironmaster.
- ✓ C) He felt he had redeemed himself and deserved the title.
- D) He was inspired by the ironmaster's mistake.



NCERT Questions

- ✓ Q. How does the peddler interpret the acts of kindness and hospitality shown by the crofter, the ironmaster and his daughter?
- ✓ Q. What are the instances in the story that show that the character of the ironmaster is different from that of his daughter in many ways?
- ✓ Q. The story has many instances of unexpected reactions from the characters to others' behaviour. Pick out instances of these surprises.
- ✓ Q. What made the peddler finally change his ways? ★ ★
- ✓ Q. How does the metaphor of the rattrap serve to highlight the human predicament? ★
- ✓ Q. The peddler comes out as a person with a subtle sense of humour. How does this serve in lightening the seriousness of the theme of the story and also endear him to us?

Glossary



- **Resort to** : to turn to
- **Petty** : insignificant; trivial
- **Thievery** : stealing
- **Keep body and soul together** : to manage to keep existing, especially when one has very little money
- **Gleamed** : shone
- **Monotonous** : boring
- **Vagabond** : a wanderer; a person without a permanent home who moves from place to place
- **Plod** : trudge; to walk laboriously
- **Meditations** : deep thoughts
- **Baits** : traps

- **Snare** : trap
- **Trudging** : walking tiredly
- **Supper** : the evening meal
- **Carved off** : cut a big piece from
- **Generous with his confidences** : he could easily share his secrets with anybody
- **Crofter** : a person in scotland who rents or owns a small farm adjoining a house
- **Bossy** : (here) cow
- **Creamery** : factory producing dairy products
- **Kronor** : a unit of money in Sweden
- **Incredulous** : unbelievable
- **Nodding** : moving head to express agreement
- **Stuffed** : pushed quickly and carelessly
- **Thickets** : bushes

- **Peddler** : a person who sells things moving door to door
- **Impenetrable** : that cannot be entered, passed through or seen through
- **Descending** : coming down
- **Gloom** : sorrow
- **Despair** : disappointment
- **Summoned** : (here) gathered
- **Staggered** : walked unsteadily
- **Smelter** : an industrial plant for smelting
- **Rolling mill** : a factory that produces metal sheets
- **Forge** : a blacksmith's workshop
- **Barges and scows** : flat bottomed boats
- **Sifted** : separated
- **Crates** : big containers

- **Furnace** : chamber for intense heating by fire
- **Pig iron** : raw iron
- **Anvil** : a heavy block of iron or steel with a smooth, flat top on which metals are shaped by hammering
- **Perspiration** : sweat
- **Bellows** : device for driving air into fire
- **Shovelled** : threw in a rough or hasty way
- **Maw** : something that seems like a big mouth and swallows up things completely
- **Clatter** : aloud noise
- **Vagabonds** : wanderers
- **Sooty** : blackish or dusty in colour
- **Dangling** : hanging or swinging freely
- **Intruder** : a one who enters a building, ground etc. Without permission

- **Consent** : to agree or to allow
- **Tramp** : a person with no home or job who travels from place to place asking for food or money
- **Ragamuffin** : a shabbily clothed person
- **Deigned** : to think fit; considered worthy
- **Slouch hat** : hat with wide flexible brim
- **Undeceive** : to reveal the truth to (someone previously misled)
- **Regiment** : a military unit
- **Comrade** : a close friend one has worked with
- **Downhill** : on a decline
- **Manor** : large country house with lands
- **Sneak away** : go away secretly
- **Slouch hat** : hat with wide flexible brim

- **Undeceive** : to reveal the truth to (someone previously misled)
- **Regiment** : a military unit
- **Comrade** : a close friend one has worked with
- **Manor** : large country house with lands
- **Sneak away** : go away secretly
- **Inconspicuously** : without being noticed
- **Assumed** : thought that it was true without
- **Persuasion** : knowing the truth
- **Valet** : a gentleman's personal servant
- **Apprentice** : a job trainee
- **To sleep with one eye open** : to have a light sleep
- **Abruptly** : suddenly
- **Compassionately** : sympathetically

- **Forebodings** : strong feelings that something unpleasant or dangerous is going to happen
- **Queer** : strange
- **Well groomed** : looking clean, neat and well dressed
- **Puckered** : wrinkled
- **Dissimulate** : to disguise or pretend
- **Splendour** : grandeur
- **Sheriff** : an officer to maintain law and order
- **Rind** : thick outer skin
- **Wretch** : an unhappy or unfortunate person
- **Interceded** : pleaded in favour of
- **Mumbled** : muttered
- **Parson** : priest
- **A tone stretch** : non-stop; in one go

Key Notes

A poor vagabond

- A hapless victim of want and hunger
- Sells rattraps out of begged material to make both ends meet
- Resorts to begging and stealing for additional income



The vagabond's sombre thought

- The whole world's a big rattrap
- All comforts and joys are nothing but baits to trap
- Succumbing to temptation spells end of everything
- Vagabond enjoys dwelling on this thought during lonely plodding's



A generous host

- Seeks shelter in a small gray cottage by the roadside
- Owner, an old man without wife or children, accommodates him
- Feeds him porridge and treats kindly
- The two smoke and play cards together



The host confides in the vagabond

- Host formerly a crofter at ramsjö ironworks
- Now supported by a milch cow
- Earned thirty kronor in payment last month
- Shows the amount saved in a pouch hung on a nail near the window frame



Vagabond steals the money

- Next morning the guest thanks the old man, bids goodbye and goes his own way
- Host locks the house; goes to milk the COW
- Guest returns after half an hour
- Smashes the windowpane
- Steals the money and runs away



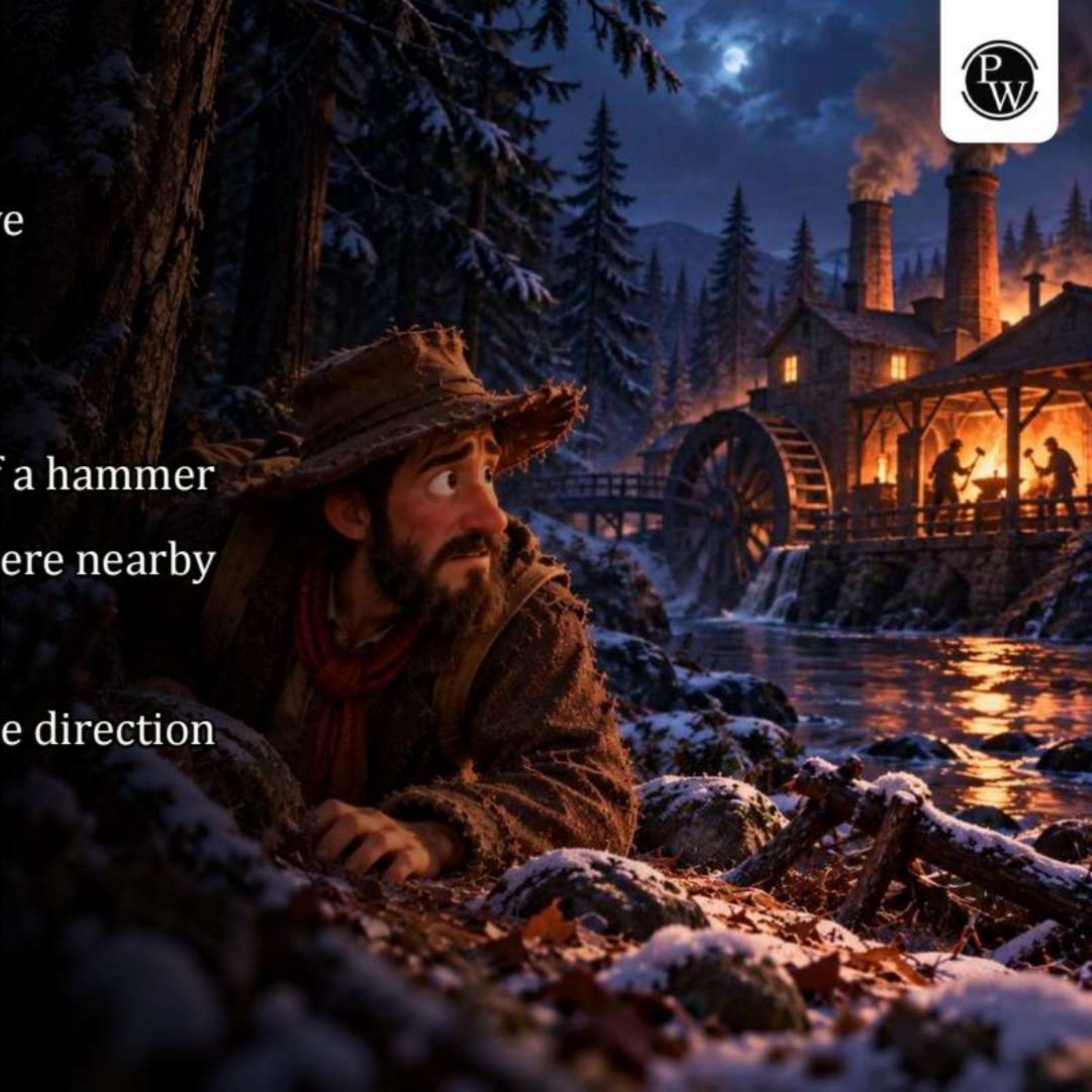
Lost in the forest

- Vagabond discards public highway to avoid getting caught
- Turns off the road into the woods
- Walks through mazes of forest paths
- Lands nowhere as the forest was big and confusing
- Dead tired; realises that he has been trapped
- Forest an impenetrable prison; escape impossible



A hope in the darkness

- Vagabond dejected and apprehensive
- Sees no way out
- Sinks to the ground in despair
- Suddenly hears regular thumping of a hammer
- Realises that an iron mill is somewhere nearby
- Gets another lease of life
- Gathers his strength and walks in the direction of the sound
- Reaches Ramsjo ironworks
- Work in full swing; very noisy place



Vagabond sneaks into the mill unnoticed

- Opens the gate and enters the forge
- Seeks permission from the master blacksmith to stay overnight
- Permission granted but coldly
- Lies down to sleep close to the furnace in order to warm himself



Ironmaster's nightly visit

- Owner of the mill particular about quality product
- Makes regular nightly rounds to monitor quality of work
- Presence of the vagabond catches his attention; looks at him very closely
- Mistakes him for captain nils olof, an old regimental comrade
- Hoping to get some money from the ironmaster, the vagabond doesn't deny his identity
- Ironmaster invites him to his manor house



Tramp declines ironmaster's invitation

- Tramp alarmed due to fear of detection of thirty kronor
- Vehemently refuses to go up to the manor house
- Ironmaster assumes captain embarrassed of his ragged clothes
- Tries to allay his fears



Tramp declines ironmaster's invitation

- Tells him about his sons being abroad and wife Elizabeth being dead
- Assures him that it won't be embarrassing to come to the manor house with only his oldest daughter around
- Invites the tramp to give company for Christmas
- Finally gives up due to the tramp's repeated refusals and goes away



Ironmaster sends daughter to persuade the guest

- Within half an hour, the daughter of ironmaster arrives
- Daughter not pretty but modest and shy
- As she approaches him, the tramp gets up alarmed and quite frightened
- The daughter introduces herself as Edla willmansson
- Extends invitation again
- Tells he could leave after Christmas anytime



Rattrap peddler changes his mind

- Gives consent to accompany Edla
- Covers himself with furcoat carried by the lady's valet
- Touched by the girl's warmth, friendly & sympathetic attitude
- On the way to the manor house, his conscience pricked him about the stolen money in his pocket
- Feels himself to be trapped never to be released



The ironmaster's plan and his daughter's concern

- The ironmaster decides to get some flesh on his friend's thin and weak body
- Plans to get him to do something better than selling rattraps
- His daughter expresses surprise at the captain's worsening fortune
- Adds that he showed no signs of being an educated person



Ironmaster's hopes about the Captain

- Sure, of his getting over tramp manners on getting groomed
- Asks his daughter to have patience
- Expects to find world of difference in the guest's appearance on getting clean



The guest's entry shocks ironmaster

- The guest is totally transformed after bath, shave and change of clothes
- Presented before the ironmaster in broad day light
- However, the well-groomed guest bears no resemblance to the old regimental comrade
- Ironmaster not pleased; demands explanation
- The guest defends himself saying he made no pretence about being a captain
- Reminds that he pleaded to be allowed to stay in the forge
- Offers to change into his own rags and leave



Ironmaster's hopes about the Captain

- Sure, of his getting over tramp manners on getting groomed
- Asks his daughter to have patience
- Expects to find world of difference in the guest's appearance on getting clean



The guest's entry shocks ironmaster

- The guest is totally transformed after bath, shave and change of clothes
- Presented before the ironmaster in broad day light
- However, the well-groomed guest bears no resemblance to the old regimental comrade
- Ironmaster not pleased; demands explanation
- The guest defends himself saying he made no pretence about being a captain
- Reminds that he pleaded to be allowed to stay in the forge
- Offers to change into his own rags and leave



Ironmaster's displeasure and threat

- Insists the tramp's behaviour was dishonest
- Expresses his intention to take the matter to the sheriff



The tramp gives a piece of his mind

- The tramp flares up; hits the table with his fist
- Clarifies: the whole world is a rattrap; all offers bear resemblance to bait used to trap
- He did not fear being locked up by the sheriff but insisted that ironmaster too wasn't infallible
- He too might be allured and trapped some day



Ironmaster convinced by the argument

- Ironmaster impressed with tramp's arguments
- Drops the idea of contacting the sheriff asks him to leave immediately



Edla's intervention

- Wishes the tramp to stay back
- Feels that turning him out after promising Christmas cheer would be unfair
- Feels sorry for this wretch, wanted and welcomed by none
- Pleads that for once he deserves a kinder treatment
- The father gives in
- Man brought to the table and fed
- He wonders about Edla's motive



Long hours of sleep

- After sharing Christmas fare, the stranger sleeps the whole afternoon
- Wakes up for Christmas delicacies
- Goes off to sleep again
- Seems as though he had not slept in such peace and safety for years
- Participates in lighting the Christmas tree
- Later Christmas fish and porridge is served to him



After the Christmas dinner



- The tramp thanks and wishes good night to everyone present
- The girl tells him to keep his father's suit as a Christmas gift
- Extends invitation for the Christmas next year
- The tramp feels amazed at her words



Morning after Christmas

- Leaving behind the sleeping guest, father and daughter go off to the church
- After the service return home having heard from the church about the tramp's thievery
- The girl feels very dejected
- Father unhappy about letting the tramp into the house
- Fears that the tramp must have disappeared with their silver ware
- Is informed by the valet that the stranger has left but empty handed
- Has left behind a Christmas present for Edla

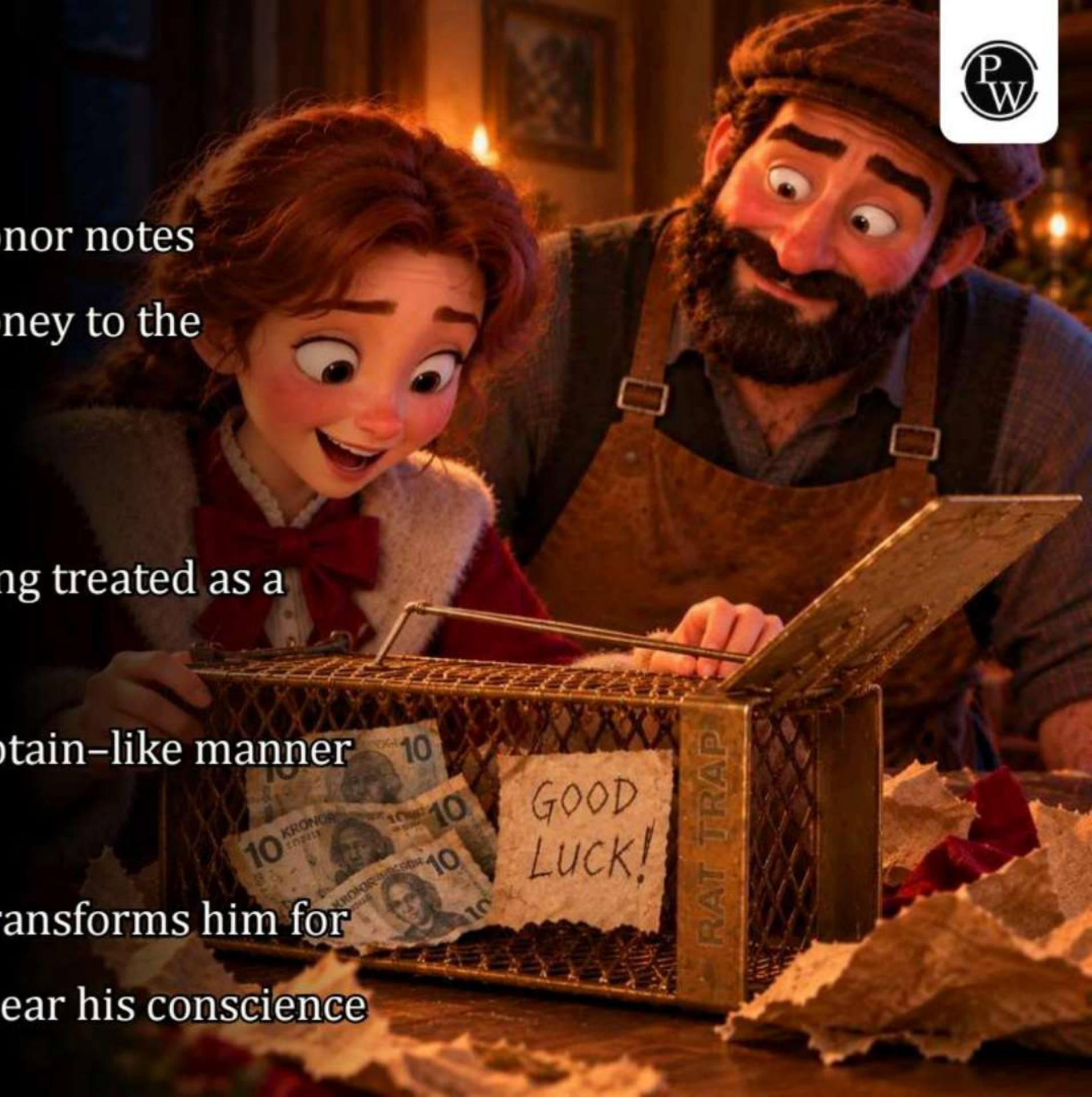


Edla opens the present

- An ill-packed package
- Inside it is a rattrap with three ten kronor notes
- The guest wishes her to return the money to the owner

A captain-like gesture

- The tramp expresses gratitude for being treated as a captain
- Reciprocates gesture in a dignified captain-like manner
- Signs his name as Captain von Stahle
- The girl's treating him like a captain transforms him for the better and gives him a chance to clear his conscience



AN



@ANURAGSIREGLISH



THANK YOU...!!